MODULE 5 WORKSHEET

# Win Before You Begin Preparation Planner

Expert negotiators spend three to five hours preparing for every hour at the table. This planner takes you through the ultimate preparation checklist. Fill it in before an important negotiation, and finish with the review afterwards.

**Negotiation I'm preparing for:** _____ **Date:** _____

## 01 Goals, walk-away point and priorities

| LAYER | FOR THIS NEGOTIATION |
|---|---|
| **Ideal outcome**<br>The best realistic result | |
| **Minimum outcome / walk-away point**<br>Below this, my BATNA is better. Write it down. | |

| MUST-HAVE (PROTECT) | IMPORTANT (PUSH, BUT CAN FLEX) | TRADEABLE (GIVE TO GET) |
|---|---|---|
| | | |

**Remember:** aim at your ideal during the negotiation, and judge the result against your walk-away point.

## 02 My BATNA

"If I don't get this, what will I do instead?" List your alternatives, including internal ones, and rank them.

| # | ALTERNATIVE | VALUE (PRACTICAL, FINANCIAL, EMOTIONAL) | TESTED? (QUOTE, MEETING) |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1 | | | ☐ Yes |
| 2 | | | ☐ Yes |
| 3 | | | ☐ Yes |

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**My BATNA in one sentence** ("If I can't … by …, I'll …")

**Strength today:** ☐ Weak ☐ Moderate ☐ Strong

| STRENGTHEN IT BEFORE I START | MY ACTION | BY WHEN |
|---|---|---|
| ☐ Do market research | | |
| ☐ Build relationships early | | |
| ☐ Develop an internal solution | | |
| ☐ Test my fallback | | |
| ☐ Improve my credibility | | |

**How I will signal it: confidence, not a threat** (only after rapport, e.g. "We're also exploring other options, but I'd like to make this work with you.")

## 03 Their BATNA

| STEP | WHAT I FOUND OR WILL LOOK FOR |
|---|---|
| **Research** deals, partnerships, public statements, pressures, deadlines | |
| **Subtle questions** "How critical is this timeline for your team?" | |
| **Clues to listen for** hesitation, urgency, overconfidence, body language | |
| **Their likely alternatives** strongest to weakest | |

**My estimate:** ☐ Weak, so I'll emphasise the unique value I provide ☐ Strong, so I'll focus on partnership and value beyond price

**ZOPA estimate** (the zone between both walk-away points)

My walk-away point: _____ Their likely limit: _____ Zone: _____ to _____ ☐ No overlap

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## 04 Leverage map

Write one example of each. Blend them, keep a collaborative tone, and watch for shifts as new information appears.

### Positive

What they want: "If you do this, I can give you..."

### Negative

What they fear losing: "If not, you risk..."

### Normative

What they believe in: "Based on what you've said..."

## 05 Execution plan

| STEP | MY PLAN |
| --- | --- |
| **1 · Plan the path**<br>Scope; easy issues first, tough ones later; team roles | |
| **2 · Set the stage**<br>Agenda, tone, who decides | |
| **3 · Explore interests**<br>Open questions I will ask | |
| **4 · Shape and trade**<br>"If we do X, could you do Y?" | |
| **5 · Close and confirm**<br>Summary, next steps, written follow-up | |

### Obstacles I expect, and my response

### Ways to create value beyond price

**Logistics:** venue _____ medium ☐ in person ☐ video ☐ phone timing _____ note-taker _____

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## 06 Final check before I walk in

- [ ] My ideal, walk-away point and trade-offs are written down.
- [ ] My BATNA is real and tested, and I know how I'll signal it.
- [ ] I know their priorities, constraints, style and likely BATNA.
- [ ] I have positive, negative and normative leverage ready.
- [ ] I have planned for obstacles and know where I can be flexible.
- [ ] I have ideas for creating mutual value beyond price.
- [ ] I have planned the order of topics and how I'll open.
- [ ] Logistics are set, and I will keep detailed notes.

## 07 After-action review

Fill this in within 24 hours of the negotiation.

| QUESTION | WHAT HAPPENED |
|---|---|
| How did the result compare with my ideal and my walk-away point? | |
| Did I use my BATNA as confidence, not a threat? Was the timing right? | |
| What did I learn about their BATNA that I hadn't expected? | |
| Which leverage worked? Did leverage shift during the talk? | |
| What will I prepare differently next time? | |

**Agreed next steps (what, who, by when):**

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